NOVARTIS | Reimagining Medicine



Corporate Affairs

Novartis Communications Style Guide

March 2024

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About this document

This document is meant to help communicators create corporate content that is clear and effective for people who are nonspecialists and may not be native English speakers, while ensuring a consistent style and tone of voice.

Novartis uses American English in its corporate publications.

The company follows **Webster's New World College Dictionary** and **The Associated Press (AP) Stylebook**. Online versions are located at www.apstylebook.com/novartis (accessible to anyone with a Novartis computer on the Novartis network).

This style guide addresses Novartis-specific exceptions to the AP Stylebook and highlights the AP Style rules most relevant to Novartis. It also covers basic elements of clear communications, the Novartis tone of voice, and detailed points of style on Novartis and industry-specific terms in English.

Please address questions about this style guide to Malcolm Shearmur at malcolm.shearmur@novartis.com.

Please note: A separate "OneNovartis Innovative Medicines US Editorial Style Guide for Promotional Materials" provides editorial guidance on promotional material submitted through the Materials Approval Process (MAP). It is largely based on the AMA Manual of Style, 11th Edition, with any Novartis exceptions noted. For more information, or if you are unsure which style guide to reference, please contact Gerry Scharfenberger at gerry.scharfenberger@novartis.com.

1. General

1.1. Tone of voice

Our brand is built not only on what we say, but also how we say it. The Novartis tone of voice is the tone, style and word choice we use in our communications. Just like a person's voice, our brand voice should be unique and recognizable. When used consistently, it sets us apart in our industry.

Our tone of voice is based on four principles, providing flexibility to modulate depending on audience and context.

Engaged and optimistic: We emphasize the energy and passion we bring to our purpose. We convey a sense of wonder about the possibilities of medical science — while always showing what it means for people.

- **Engaged,** not arrogant
- **Energized**, not academic
- **Optimistic**, not abstract

Curious and collaborative: We emphasize the never-ending process of learning and discovery that is inherent to our purpose. We embrace diverse ideas and encourage dialogue with others.

- **Interested**, not know-it-all
- **Open**, not aloof
- **Self-aware**, not self-important

Empathetic and relatable: We emphasize the human side of our purpose. We help people navigate the experience of disease and medicine. We recognize that we don't have all the answers and we raise the voices of others.

- **Human**, not distant
- **Humble**, not superior
- **Collaborative**, not exclusive

Clear and accurate: Whatever the message, we always speak with clarity and accuracy. We use good, plain English to communicate in a simple (but never dumbed-down) way. We are never patronizing or unserious when talking about people's health.

- **Clear, not cluttered**
- **Conversational, not formal**
- **Succinct, not verbose**

For more information — including do's and don'ts and examples of how to use each element — see the separate Tone of Voice document.

1.2. Usage

Third-person language

Novartis corporate content can be written from a third-person perspective, e.g., "Novartis is an innovative medicines company," or can use pronouns, e.g., "We are an innovative medicines company."

Inclusive language

Use capital letters for both the terms "Black" and "White" in racial, ethnic and cultural senses (same usage as in the AMA Manual of Style). Otherwise, follow AP Style for inclusive language on race and ethnicity; gender, sex and sexual orientation; and disabilities.

See also the Novartis Inclusive Communications Guide for additional background and guidance on inclusive language and imagery.

Use of foreign words and names

Limit the use of foreign words as much as possible. Particular care should be taken with the names of Novartis companies that include words in languages other than English. Ensure that accents are correct and correctly placed, e.g., Santé, S.à.r.l.

When writing in English, umlauts in German names should be replaced with the underlying vowel and an “e”:

- Joerg Reinhardt, not Jörg Reinhardt
- “ae,” not “ä”

Foreign words are not italicized in English.

2. Typography and punctuation

2.1. Typography

The typeface for Novartis texts is Volta Modern. When Volta Modern is not available, such as in Microsoft Office applications or online communications, use the system fonts Arial Black and Arial. For details, refer to the Novartis Brand Lab: novartisbrandlab.com.

2.2. Alignment

Headlines and body text should be aligned left.

2.3. Hyphenation

Following AP Style, use hyphens to avoid ambiguity or to form a single idea from two or more words:

- community-acquired pneumonia
- single-pill combinations

Their use is not standardized and can be omitted if the meaning is clear:

- human rights targets
- greenhouse gas emissions

No hyphen is required with adverbs (e.g., “very” or words ending in “ly”):

- publicly listed company

For a list of common hyphenation conventions, including exceptions, please see Appendix A1.

2.4. Abbreviations and acronyms

Spell out abbreviations and acronyms on first reference, followed by the abbreviation in parentheses. The abbreviation may be used alone on second reference:

- World Health Organization (WHO)
- US Food and Drug Administration (FDA)

Do not use periods in abbreviations and acronyms, including those with two letters, except for those listed under “Titles” below.

For guidelines specifically related to executive and Board member CVs, please see Appendix A4.

Names of months

The names of months may be abbreviated in tables (without periods):

Jan	Apr	Jul	Oct
Feb	May	Aug	Nov
Mar	Jun	Sep	Dec

Titles

The following abbreviations are written with periods: Mr., Ms., Dr., M.D., Prof., Ph.D.

Ampersand (&)

An ampersand should not be used in place of “and” in general text. Ampersands are acceptable in abbreviations of the following (but spell out on first reference):

- Diversity and inclusion (D&I)

- Integrity and compliance (I&C)
- Research and development (R&D)
- Novartis Values and Behaviors (V&Bs)

Exceptions:
Some Novartis global functions (see section 5.2) and Board committees (e.g., the Science & Technology Committee) use ampersands in their formal names.

The same rules apply online (Novartis.com), meaning ampersands are allowed only if part of a proper name (including in page/major section headings).

2.5. Bulleted lists

Bulleted lists should start with the same word form (noun, verb, etc.). Always capitalize the first word of each bullet point. Only use a period at the end of a bulleted point if it is a full sentence.

Example 1 (not full sentences):

The primary responsibilities of the Board include:

- Deciding on the ultimate direction of the company's business
- Determining major changes in the company's structure and organization
- Overseeing the company's ethics and compliance framework

Example 2 (full sentences):

Dengue fever and tuberculosis collectively were selected as the diseases on which to focus, with the possibility to expand to other disease areas in later years:

- Tuberculosis (TB) is a leading cause of death and disease worldwide. TB is a bacterial infection caused by Mycobacterium tuberculosis. According to the World Health Organization (WHO), close to 8 million people become infected and 2 million die from TB every year.
- Dengue and dengue hemorrhagic fever (DHF) are caused by four closely related viral strains. The virus is transmitted to humans through the bites of infected mosquitoes.

2.6. Quotations

Following AP Style, quotations should be enclosed within double quotation marks (“/”). Punctuation is generally placed within the quotation marks: “This quarter's performance was exceptional,” the CEO said.

Also use double quotation marks when referring to projects and initiatives, another section of a document, or to emphasize specific words or phrases.
E.g.,

- The “My Cancer. My Words.” campaign emphasizes the need to pay attention to the words we use when talking about or describing cancer.
- See “3.5 Product names” for our style on brand names and development compounds.
- Within our “two plus three” approach to technology platforms, we focus our development resources on our priority assets.

However, use single quotation marks within a quote, or none at all if using a hyperlink: E.g.,

- “The ‘My Cancer. My Words.’ campaign emphasizes the need to pay attention to the words we use when talking about or describing cancer,” said xxx.
- See 3.5 Product names for our style on brand names and development compounds.

2.7. Capitalization and spelling

In accordance with AP Style, Novartis follows general American English rules on capitalization (only capitalize proper nouns, e.g., official names) and spelling, with certain exceptions outlined in section 4.1 and section 5).

The words below should be written as follows:

- payer (not payor)
- web (lowercase)
- internet (lowercase)
- Biomedical (uppercase “B” in reference to the Biomedical Research organizational unit; “biomedical” in other instances)

Because capitalization can make sentences hard to read, keep it to a minimum by using descriptive alternatives where possible (e.g., “Novartis has policies to ensure employees and suppliers do business ethically” instead of “Novartis has a Doing Business Ethically policy for employees as well as a Third Party Code and Anti-Bribery Third Party Guideline for suppliers”).

3. Units, symbols and numbers

3.1. Figures

Both cardinal numbers (one, two, three, etc.) and ordinal numbers (first, second, third, etc.) from one to nine and first to ninth should be written out in full; 10 (10th) and above should be written as a numeral. Sentences should never begin with a numeral, except one that identifies a calendar year. Spell out numerals or recast the sentence.

Figures of 100 and above should be grouped into place values of threes, with a nonbreaking space (Ctrl+Shift+Space in Word; Alt+0160 in PowerPoint) between the thousands to avoid separation at the end of a line:

- 5 000
- 500 000

This style does not apply to media releases, which use commas. Do not use inverted commas (the German style) in English language media releases or other documents:

- 5,000
- 500,000

Numbers preceding a unit of measure should be written as a numeral followed by the unit written out in full if a million or more:

- 500 million
- 3 billion

Exception: In charts and tables, “m,” “bn” and “tn” may be used for million, billion and trillion.

The % sign is used rather than the word “percent.”

There should be no space between the numeral and a unit’s symbol:

- 2%
- 14.7°C (no space between degree symbol and letter)

Use Roman numerals to designate the different phases of clinical trials and capitalize the word “Phase”:

- Phase I/II/III

When describing a ranking, write “No. 1” (not “number one” or “#1”).

When describing a change in percentage-point terms, do not add “.0” after whole numbers (e.g., write “6 percentage points” — not “6.0 percentage points”).

The following always are written as numerals:

- Job levels within Novartis (1 to 10)
- Articles and paragraphs of legal texts (Art. 7 para. 2)
- Ratios, ranges (from 6 to 20 years) and currencies (USD 5 million)
- Ages of people and animals (express as “5 years old,” not “5 years of age”), but not of inanimates (e.g., “the law came into force three years ago;” “the building will take two years to complete.”)
- Terms such as “type 2 diabetes”

3.2. Currencies

International Organization for Standardization (ISO) abbreviations are used for currencies:

- USD 570 million
- EUR 570 million
- CHF 570 million

The currency name, numeral and any qualifiers should not break a line. To ensure this does not happen, use a nonbreaking space (Ctrl+Shift+Space in Word; Alt+0160 in PowerPoint) between each item.

Write out “local currency” and “constant currencies” on first reference, followed by the abbreviation in parentheses. The abbreviations “(lc)” and “(cc)” may be used in charts or tables with space constraints.

3.3. Dates and times

Dates should be written in the form “month, day, year” (e.g., December 31, 2024). Month names may be abbreviated in charts (e.g., Dec 31).

Times should be given using the 24-hour clock, with hours and minutes separated by a colon: 5:15 or 17:15.

Time spans should be written using the complete year, e.g., “from 2021 to 2022” or “between 2021 and 2022.”

3.4. Telephone numbers

Telephone numbers should include an international dialing code and should not break a line:
+41 61 324 1111 (office).

3.5. Product names

Brand names

In headlines and on first reference in a text, product brand names should include a trademark symbol in superscript, followed by the generic name in parentheses:

- Diovan® (valsartan)

Subsequent references to the brand name should appear without a trademark symbol:

- Diovan

In some publications, including the Annual Report/Form 20-F, Novartis in Society Integrated Report, quarterly reports and press kits, Novartis brand names are italicized, without a trademark symbol. In this case, the following statement must be included: “All product names printed in italics are trademarks owned by or licensed to Novartis.” In these publications, an additional description is italicized only if it is part of the registered brand name (e.g.,*Sandostatin LAR* and *Sandostatin* SC; *Exforge HCT*), while gene symbols are not italicized (e.g., RLBP1, RPE65, etc.), to avoid confusion with the rule on italicizing Novartis brand names.

The possessive form of product names (e.g., Entresto’s) should never be used.

Brand names owned by other companies are written in normal text type and include a trademark symbol in superscript on every reference:

- Lipitor®

Development compounds

On first reference, development compounds are identified by their research number, followed by the generic name in parentheses:

- LOU064 (remibrutinib)

The research number may stand alone in subsequent references.

The abbreviation for a biological entity is never changed — e.g., the first letter of “mGluR5” always is written in lowercase, even at the beginning of a sentence.

4. Layout

4.1. Headlines

In headlines of media releases, web stories, tables and other Novartis text, only the first word and proper nouns should be capitalized:

- Science underpinning hope
- Beyond the traditional role of a mother
- Novartis nominates new member for election to Board of Directors
- New sustainability strategy presented to Executive Committee

The headline style also applies to text for the main navigation and footer of corporate websites, except for the following terms:

- General Meetings
- American Depositary Receipts (ADR)

For the capitalization of Novartis-specific terms, see section 5.

4.2. Footnotes

Footnotes are indicated in the text by a superscript number without parentheses. There is no space between the number and the word that precedes it:

- Water emissions[1]

Avoid footnote numbers on other numbers (where this is not possible, insert a space between the two). Accidental changes in formatting can lead to big errors (e.g., “USD 87[1] million” would become “USD 871 million” if the formatting were accidentally changed)

Footnote numbers are placed after all punctuation marks except the dash and quotation marks:

- “...water emissions.[1]”

The relevant footnote is preceded by the corresponding number in superscript, with a space between the two:

- [1]To wastewater treatment plant excluding cooling water

Footnote text should be two font sizes smaller than the body text. Footnotes for graphs should be placed directly below the graph, not at the bottom of the page. Only use a period at the end of a footnote if it is a full sentence.

4.3. Bibliographical references

In the medical field, the standard for citing sources is International Committee of Medical Journal Editors style, better known as the Vancouver style:

- Ahlskog JE, Muenter MD. Frequency of levodopa-related dyskinesias and motor fluctuations as estimated from the cumulative literature. Movement Disorders 2001; 16: 448-458.

Bibliographical references should be reproduced unchanged in translations.

5. Novartis-specific conventions

5.1. Company name

Novartis is a joint stock corporation with headquarters in Basel, Switzerland. The company's official name is Novartis AG. "Novartis" is the preferred term for the entire enterprise. With the exception of the Annual Report/Form 20-F, the word "company" when referring to Novartis is not capitalized.

Possessive forms of the name Novartis (Novartis's, Novartis') should not be used.

5.2. Company structure and naming convention

Novartis is an integrated, innovative medicines company. It has no divisions or business units, and should not be referred to as a "group."[1]

Organizational units

Organizational units represent the parts of the company along the research and development/ production/commercialization continuum. These are **Biomedical Research**, **Development**, **Operations**,[2] and the two commercial units: **US**, focused on the US healthcare market, and **International**, focused on healthcare markets in Europe, Asia/Africa/Australasia, Canada and Latin America.

The names of Novartis organizational units should always be capitalized. The words "organizational unit" should be lowercase.

It is acceptable to refer to organizational units as "units" on second reference. Biomedical Research and Development can be referred to collectively as our "Research and Development" (or "R&D" on second reference) units. Do not abbreviate the names of organizational units.
E.g.,

- Our US and International organizational units offer patent-protected medicines to patients and physicians in their respective geographies.
- Our operations organizational unit operates 33 production sites worldwide. The unit also manages our contract manufacturing activities.
- Approximately 18000 employees work in our Research and Development organizational units.

The visibility of the company is defined by **Novartis**. The organizational units should be less visible in external communications but used in the Annual Report/Form 20-F, Novartis in Society Integrated Report, financial reporting, corporate website, corporate brochures and boilerplates.

Therapeutic areas

The company focuses on four core therapeutic areas. If listed, order them alphabetically:

- Cardiovascular, renal and metabolic (CRM can be used on second reference)
- Immunology
- Neuroscience
- Oncology

We also have research, development and in-market programs in other therapeutic areas, including ophthalmology, respiratory and global health. Note that global health is only capitalized when referring to the Novartis Global Health organization.

[1] The exception is in legal documents related to the provisions of the Swiss Code of Obligations, including but not limited to governance documents of the Board, AGM materials and other documents issued by the Board, and the governance and compensation sections of our annual reporting suite.

[2] Operations has elements of both organizational unit (e.g., Technical Operations — TechOps; Contract Development & Manufacturing Organization — CDMO) and global function (e.g., Data, Digital & Information Technology — DD&IT; Real Estate & Procurement; Global Business Solutions).

The four core therapeutic areas determine our main categories for financial reporting. Other branded products are grouped under the following categories for financial reporting:

- Other promoted brands (comprising the respiratory and ophthalmology therapeutic areas)
- Established brands (including our contract manufacturing operations[3])

Do not capitalize the names of therapeutic areas / reporting categories since they are not proper nouns, i.e., they do not refer to Novartis organizational units.
E.g.,

- Our core therapeutic areas are cardiovascular, renal and metabolic; immunology; neuroscience; and oncology.
- Sales in the neuroscience therapeutic area were USD 5.1 billion.
- Sales of established brands increased from the previous year.

Global functions

Global functions support the organizational units and execution of overall company governance and strategy. These are:

- Finance
- People & Organization (P&O)
- Legal[4]
- Ethics, Risk & Compliance (ERC)
- Corporate Affairs (CA)
- Strategy & Growth (S&G)
- Internal Audit (IA)

Some global functions have established abbreviations, as shown above. Only use these after spelling out the full name on first reference. Always capitalize the names of global functions (but the words “global functions” should be lowercase). It is acceptable to refer to them as “functions” on second reference. It is not acceptable to refer to global functions as “Group” functions.
E.g.,

- Novartis global functions include Legal, and Corporate Affairs.
- They work in our US Strategy & Growth function.

“Global” can also be used in the names of teams or departments within a function that have global responsibilities. Do not use “Group.”
E.g.,

- Global FRA

Acquired companies

Where there is reason to retain an acquired company’s name during a transition phase before full integration, the phrase “a Novartis company” should be added:

E.g.,

- Chinook Therapeutics, a Novartis company

[3] Contract manufacturing activities are managed by the Operations organizational unit.

[4] In internal communications, use Security & Legal (S&L) as the name of the function.

5.3. Governance bodies

Names of Novartis governance bodies (e.g., “Executive Committee of Novartis,” “Board of Directors”) should be capitalized. However, “board” should not be capitalized when referring to other organizations, unless part of a formal name.

5.4. Employees and professional titles

In annual company reports, use the word “employee” rather than “associate” to refer to someone who holds a contract with a Novartis company, to avoid potential misinterpretation.

The abbreviation “Dr.” should be used only for medical doctors and not for someone with a doctorate/Ph.D. (This rule does not apply to German texts, including German CVs. “Dr.” should be used for those who earned relevant academic degrees in German-speaking countries.)

Additional guidance on titles of Novartis senior leaders is provided in Appendix A4.

5.5. Proper names

Proper names include the following and should be capitalized:

- Novartis Values and Behaviors
- Novartis Code of Ethics
- Novartis Share Register
- Novartis Top Leaders
- Compensation Report
- Annual Incentive/Long-Term Incentives
- Long-Term Performance Plan

The list above is not exhaustive. Generally, capitalize when you are referring to a proper noun (e.g., the formal names of departments, policies, processes, etc.)

5.6. Corporate trademarks

Corporate trademarks must either include a trademark symbol (®) or be italicized, depending on where they appear (see section 3.5). Examples include:

- Novartis Access®
- Arogya Parivar®
- Familia Nawiri®
- Cùng Sông Khoe®

5.7. Boilerplates/disclaimers

Check the most recent media release on the Novartis corporate website for the most up-to-date version of the standard Novartis boilerplate.

There is no standard disclaimer. All disclaimers must be adapted by Legal for each specific release.

5.8. Environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics

The performance of companies on ESG topics (including but not limited to innovation, access, human capital, environmental sustainability, ethical standards and corporate governance) is an area of increasing focus for investors and other audiences.

When writing about ESG topics, avoid overstated or potentially misleading language that may be construed as “greenwashing.” For instance, avoid words or phrases that are overly general or

aspirational, that cannot be objectively verified or that may create unrealistic expectations for readers. E.g., “nonnegotiable;” “is at the core of everything we do;” “in every interaction;” “must always come first.”

Be precise in your use of language. E.g., “water use” and “water consumption” have different meanings in ESG disclosures. Check the Novartis in Society Integrated Report for correct usage. If in doubt, please contact malcolm.shearmur@novartis.com.

Note that any new or significantly updated disclosures on ESG topics need to be approved by the ESG Committee (ECN-level). Please contact the Sustainability & ESG Office for more information.

6. Additional guidelines for the Novartis in Society Integrated Report

6.1. Headings and subheadings

When writing headings and subheadings, only capitalize the first word and proper nouns (e.g., Chair's letter). This rule also applies to the table of contents.

6.2. Paragraph breaks

Paragraph breaks are indicated by inserting a space between each paragraph. Indents should not be used.

6.3. Punctuation

- Do not use periods after pullout texts/quotes.
- Only use periods after photo captions that are complete sentences.
- See sections 2.5 and 4.2 for punctuation in bulleted lists and footnotes, respectively.

6.4. Scientific and medical terminology

When not abbreviated, the below should be written as follows:

- chimeric antigen receptor T-cell (CAR-T) therapy
- hormone receptor-positive (HR+)/human epidermal growth factor receptor 2-negative (HER2-) advanced or metastatic breast cancer
- anaplastic lymphoma kinase-positive (ALK+) non-small cell lung cancer
- cyclin-dependent kinase 4 and 6 (CDK4/6)
- phosphoinositide 3-kinase (PI3K)
- Janus kinase 1 and 2 (JAK1/2) inhibitor
- programmed cell death-1 (PD-1) checkpoint inhibitor
- T-cell immunoglobulin and mucin domain-3 (TIM-3)
- lymphocyte activation gene-3 (LAG-3)
- T-helper type 2 (Th2) cells
- nonalcoholic steatohepatitis
- SMA type 1/SMA type 2

6.5. Miscellaneous rules

- To help with the auditability of our non-financial reporting, avoid terms such as "generally," "regularly," "typically," "usually." Be as specific as possible, e.g., at least once per year, etc.
- It is acceptable to write "US" and "UK" in all instances rather than "United States" and "United Kingdom."
- When referencing a university or city, specify the country in which it is located.
- In pullout texts, avoid abbreviating thousand (e.g., write "6 000" instead of "6K").
- Always make the following lowercase:
  - American depositary receipts/American depositary shares
  - breakthrough therapy designation

  - priority review
  - growth products
  - balanced scorecard
  - data42
- Do not italicize “Plasmodium falciparum” or “Plasmodium vivax.”
- Always define “LMICs” as “low- and middle-income countries” in line with WHO usage.
- Use “on” or “at the end of” when describing a situation on a specific date (e.g., “on October 4, 2023, we spun off our Sandoz business;” “Novartis employed 78 407 people at the end of 2023”).
- Use “from,” “effective,” or “starting” when describing the date from which something becomes valid (e.g., “We intend to submit remibrutinib to global health authorities starting in 2024;” “We made some changes to our compensation system, effective January 1, 2024”).

7. Additional guidelines for the Annual Report/Form 20-F

7.1. Headings, subheadings and lower-level headings

Capitalize each word in the main item heading:

- Item 5. Operating and Financial Review and Prospects

Use sentence case in the lettered subheadings (i.e., only capitalize the first word and proper nouns):

- 5.A Operating results
- 5.B Liquidity and capital resources

Use sentence case in all lower-level headings and tables:

- Core operating income key figures

7.2. Figures

Use a negative sign (not parentheses) to denote negative numbers in tables:

- – 1 000

See section 3.1 for additional guidance about figures.

7.3. Bulleted lists

In the “Key marketed products” section of Item 4, do not use a period at the end of a bulleted point, even if it is a full sentence.

7.4. Common words and terms

The Annual Report/Form 20-F follows AP Style, with several exceptions. Here is how common words and terms should appear:

- American Depositary Receipts/American Depositary Shares (uppercase)
- Long-Term Performance Plan (uppercase)
- Exploratory Development/Confirmatory Development (uppercase)
- Emerging Growth Markets/Established Markets (uppercase)
- Warning Letter (uppercase)
- Annual Incentive (uppercase)
- restricted share units/performance share units (lowercase)
- research and development/marketing and sales (lowercase)
- core operating income/core gross profit (lowercase)
- Company (uppercase) when referring to Novartis; company (lowercase) when referring to other companies
- spin-off (not spinoff) when used as a noun; spin off (two words) when used as a verb
- payer (not payor)

Appendix

A1. Commonly hyphenated terms and exceptions in Novartis communications

Prefixes

Generally, do not hyphenate when using a prefix with a word starting with a consonant:

- antiviral
- anticancer
- antihypertensive
- antidepressant
- antibiotic
- antimalarial
- copay
- multidrug
- multiyear
- noncommunicable
- nonfinancial
- nonprofit
- preclinical
- precancerous
- prenatal
- prepandemic
- rebranding

Exceptions include:

- non-core
- non-prescription drug
- non-small cell lung cancer
- non-voting

Following AP Style, use a hyphen when the prefix ends with a vowel and the word that follows begins with the same vowel (“cooperate” and “coordinate” are the two exceptions):

- pre-empt, not preempt
- anti-infective, not antiinfective
- micro-organism, not microorganism

Suffixes

Following AP Style, the suffix “wide” should be used without a hyphen:

- companywide, industrywide, nationwide, worldwide

Other terms

Other common terms that should be hyphenated:

- 10-day loss
- AA-rated
- community-acquired pneumonia
- gene-silencing defense
- lost-time accidents, lost-time decreases, lost-time injuries
- not-for-profit initiative
- over-the-counter option
- prescription-to-OTC switch
- single-pill combinations
- T-cell
- year-end

Other common terms that should not be hyphenated:

- clinical outcome trial
- cost containment initiatives
- healthcare
- high blood pressure
- patient advocacy
- side effects
- waste efficiency targets
- website
- wellbeing

Common terms that may need hyphenation, depending on usage:

- first quarter — hyphenated when used to describe a noun (first-quarter results), but not hyphenated when used as a noun (in the first quarter)

- third party — hyphenated when used to describe a noun (third-party costs), but not hyphenated when used as a noun (cooperation with a third party)
- long term — hyphenated when used to describe a noun (long-term value), but not hyphenated when used as a noun (in the long term)
- spin off — hyphenated when used as a noun (the Sandoz spin-off), but not hyphenated when used as a verb (we completed our plan to spin off Sandoz)

A2. Additional AP Style writing tips

- Always "toward" — never "towards"
- Always “a.m.” and “p.m.” — never “am” and “pm”
- Always “do’s and don’ts” — never “do’s and dont’s”
- “To” instead of “in order to” — the phrase "in order" is superfluous
- “Use” instead of “utilize” — they have the same meaning, but “use” is shorter
- When to use “that” and when to use “which”: If you can drop the clause and not lose the meaning of the sentence, use “which” (otherwise, use “that”). A “which” clause is surrounded by commas; a “that” clause is not. “Which” clauses should be kept to a minimum.
  - Novartis provides healthcare solutions that address the evolving needs of patients worldwide.
  - Novartis, which provides healthcare solutions to patients worldwide, has one of the best portfolios in the industry.
- When to use “who” and when to use “that”: use “who” when referring to people and “that” when referring to inanimate objects (including organizations).
  - We are investing to ensure we can deliver our treatments to people who need them.
  - We measure the number of employees who have completed the training.
  - We seek to partner with organizations that share our purpose to improve and extend people‘s lives.

A3. COVID-19 guidelines

- Use “COVID-19” to refer to the disease. It stands for “coronavirus disease 2019.” Do not shorten to “COVID,” even in headlines, unless part of a proper name.
- Use “the COVID-19 pandemic” or “the pandemic” to refer to the event (i.e., the spread of COVID-19 around the world).
- COVID-19 is caused by a virus named SARS-CoV-2. When referring specifically to the virus, “the coronavirus,” “the COVID-19 virus” or “the virus that causes COVID-19” are acceptable.

A4. Executive and Board member CV guidance

Content requirements

Novartis is legally required to post/update in-scope executive and Board member CVs on Novartis.com on the date that changes become effective.

All Board and ECN CVs must, at a minimum, meet the requirements as set out in the SIX Directive Corporate Governance (as amended from time to time — available at http://www.ser-ag.com/en/topics/corporate-reporting.html), and in particular cover the following:

- The executive or Board member’s professional positions of at least the past 10 years, including job titles, the names of employing companies, and the time period of employment at each company

All Board and ECN CVs must, at a minimum, cover the following when describing external board memberships:

- All board membership mandates in (a) any listed company, and (b) any nonlisted company that is significantly engaged in the healthcare sector or that has/had significant business dealings with Novartis

Requests for additional content are met subject to style/consistency considerations and space availability.

Structure: Board CVs

Board CVs lead with a brief introduction (three to five sentences) summarizing each Board member's career highlights in relation to his or her key skills. The actual CVs are written in bulleted form and consist of the following sections:

- **Professional experience:** job title, formal company name, country[5] (date range)
  - Example: Chairman of the board of management and the executive committee, Bayer HealthCare AG, Germany (2010–2013)
- Mandates[6]: title, organization, country (date range, if mandate is no longer current)
  - Example 1 (current mandate): Board member, Swiss Re AG, Switzerland
  - Example 2 (past mandate): Board member, Lonza Group AG, Switzerland (2012–2013)
- Education: degree, university, country
  - Example: Doctorate in pharmaceutical sciences, Saarland University, Germany
- Key skills: main areas of expertise
  - Examples: medicine/healthcare/R&D; leadership/management; law/regulatory/risk management; finance/accounting; environmental, social and governance (ESG); data/digital

Structure: ECN CVs

ECN CVs are available on Novartis.com in both bulleted and narrative form.

The bulleted versions summarize each executive's professional experience, mandates and education using the above template for the CVs of Board members. They do not include introductory paragraphs or sections on key skills.

The narrative versions consist of between five and seven paragraphs, including a personal quote, and have a maximum word count of 350 words. These CVs take a "leadership storytelling" approach and generally cover each executive's main responsibilities, strategic focus areas and career highlights. Personal interests are an optional addition to give a more rounded profile.

Titles and board memberships

Professional and Board titles held at Novartis should be capitalized; all other titles should be lowercase.

- She is Chief Legal Officer of Novartis.
- He is Chair of the Audit and Compliance Committee.
- She is vice chair of EFPIA's Patient Access Committee.

Similarly, capital letters should be used when describing the Novartis Board of Directors. They should not be used when describing boards outside Novartis.

- She is a member of the board of directors of AXA.

[5] The country in which the executive was based. For "mandates" and "education" use the country in which the organization is based.

[6] List mandates in the following order: listed companies, nonlisted companies, other organizations. Do not disclose internal Novartis mandates. Disclose external board committee memberships only if the individual serves as committee chair.

After they are introduced in the narrative format, all ECN members should be referred to by their first name, while Board members are referred to by their family name (e.g., Mr. Moroney, Ms. Heller, Dr. Andrews).

Dates

Use the month and year to describe when each Board member was appointed.

Education

- Write “master of business administration” on first reference. “MBA” can be used on second reference.
- Use an apostrophe in “bachelor’s degree,” “master’s degree,” etc.
- If someone has a Ph.D., say he/she has or holds a doctorate and name the area of specialty.
- Make academic majors (e.g., finance, marketing, etc.) lowercase.

Abbreviations and acronyms

In bulleted CVs, refer to the United States and the United Kingdom as “US” and “UK,” respectively, in all instances.

In general, only introduce abbreviations and acronyms if they will be repeated. They may also be used if they are more common than the full-length name (e.g., IBM).

A5. Guidance on Executive and Board member titles and Board committees

Whenever possible, titles and Board committee names should remain in English for both internal and external use. Documents in German that refer to the Board’s Compensation Committee may use its German name (Vergütungsausschuss) unless other Board committees are referred to in the same document.

Up-to-date information on members of the Novartis Board of Directors and ECN is published on the company website at www.novartis.com/about/board-directors and www.novartis.com/about/executive-committee, respectively.